Part 1 Reading comprehension

Read the text and complete it with the appropriate vocabulary.

leftovers	impact	memories
convenience	responsibility	seasonal
processed	hunger	strengthen
balanced	informed	edible

Food is much more than a way of satisfying (1) ……. It reflects our culture, family traditions, personal preferences and even our social relationships. However, the way people eat has changed considerably over the past few decades. In many countries, busy lifestyles have encouraged people to choose (2) ……. over quality, and meals are increasingly eaten in front of screens rather than around a table.

One of the biggest changes is the growing popularity of (3)…….and ready-made food. These products are often affordable, easy to prepare and widely available. For people who work long hours or have little time to cook, they can be a practical solution. Nevertheless, many highly processed foods contain excessive amounts of salt, sugar and unhealthy fats. Experts often recommend a (4) ……. diet based on vegetables, fruit, whole grains and other minimally processed ingredients.

Another important issue is the environmental (5) ……. of our eating habits. Producing meat, particularly beef, generally requires more land and resources than producing many plant-based foods. Transporting ingredients over long distances and throwing away (6) ……. food can also contribute to environmental problems. As a result, some consumers are choosing to eat less meat, buy (7) ……. produce and plan their meals more carefully. Even small changes, such as using (8)……. instead of throwing them away, can make a difference.

Despite these concerns, eating sustainably is not always straightforward. Organic products may be more expensive, and fresh ingredients are not equally accessible to everyone. In some communities, people have limited access to affordable fruit and vegetables. Therefore, it would be unfair to suggest that individuals alone are responsible for changing the food system. Governments, supermarkets, restaurants and food producers also have a role to play.

Food is also deeply connected to our emotions and (9)……. . The smell of freshly baked bread may remind someone of childhood, while a traditional dish can help people maintain a connection with their cultural identity. Sharing a meal allows friends and family to spend time together, exchange ideas and (10)……. . relationships.

Ultimately, eating well does not necessarily mean following a strict diet or spending a fortune on expensive ingredients. It means making (11) ……. choices whenever possible, appreciating the food we eat and recognising its wider impact. Perhaps the real challenge is not simply to eat more healthily, but to rediscover food as a source of pleasure, connection and (12)……. .

Part 2 Reading exercises

Exercise A- Multiple choice

Choose the correct answer: A, B, C or D.

1. What is the main purpose of the text?

A. To argue that processed food should be banned.
B. To explain how eating habits affect our health, environment and social lives
C. To encourage everyone to become vegetarian.
D. To describe the history of traditional cooking.

2. Why do people often choose ready-made meals?

A. They always contain more nutrients.
B. They are more environmentally friendly.
C. They are convenient for people with busy schedules.
D. They help people maintain family traditions.

3. What does the text suggest about eating sustainably?

A. It is always cheaper than eating conventionally.
B. It depends entirely on individual decisions.
C. It is only possible in rural areas.
D. It can be difficult because access and affordability vary.

4. Why does the writer mention the smell of freshly baked bread?

A To show that food can trigger personal memories.
B. To explain how bread is produced.
C. To prove that traditional food is healthier.
D. To criticise modern cooking methods.

5. What is the writer's overall attitude towards changing eating habits?

A. Completely negative.
B. Supportive but realistic about the challenges.
C. Indifferent to environmental issues.
D. Strongly opposed to modern lifestyles.

Exercise B — True, false or not given

Write True, False or Not Given according to the text.

1. Ready-made food is always more expensive than home-cooked food.
2. Producing beef generally requires more resources than producing many plant-based foods.
3. Everyone has equal access to fresh fruit and vegetables.
4. Governments and food businesses should contribute to improving the food system.
5. The writer believes that eating well requires buying expensive ingredients.
6. Sharing meals can strengthen relationships.

Exercise C — Vocabulary in context

Find a word or phrase in the text that means:

1. Something that is easy and saves time or effort.
2. Food that has undergone substantial industrial processing.
3. Food grown or produced at a particular time of year.
4. Food left after a meal that can be eaten later.
5. The feeling of being connected to a particular culture or group.
6. Making decisions based on knowledge and understanding.

Exercise D — Short-answer questions

Answer in your own words, using complete sentences.

1. What are two disadvantages of eating highly processed food?
2. Give two examples of how consumers can reduce the environmental impact of their diets.
3. Why might it be unfair to blame individuals alone for unhealthy or unsustainable eating habits?
4. How can food bring people closer together?
5. According to the final paragraph, what does eating well really involve?

Part 3. Writing

Choose one of the following B2 writing tasks. Aim for 180-220 words.

Task 2 - Article

Your school magazine is preparing a special issue about food and healthy living. Write an engaging article entitled "Five Simple Ways to Improve Your Eating Habits."
Include:
Examples of healthy and affordable food choices.
A friendly conclusion encouraging readers to make changes.

Part 4. Useful B2 expressions

Function	Useful expressions
Giving an opinion	From my perspective... / I firmly believe that...
Adding arguments	Furthermore... / In addition to this...
Contrasting ideas	Nevertheless.../Although this may be true...
Giving examples	For instance … /A clear example of this is.....
Suggesting solutions	One possible solution would be to...
Concluding	Taking everything into consideration..